though I, being a woman, cannot myself attain sovereignty, yet my grandson Mīrzā Khān can hold it”.’ (Dughlat, 1551 p. 203)

46 Non-Muslims/ idol worshippers

47 William Erskine gives an alternative name ‘Kaliūn’to the fort and locates it in the Bādghīs district east of Herī. He and quotes from Abū’l-ghāzī in explaining of its strong position (Erskine, 1854 p. 282).

48 As per the note 1318 of Annette Susannah Beveridge, Abū’l-faẓl mentions of seeing this inscription during his period.

49 We find a lots of sources with varied opinion for Babur’s supremacist assertion of this period. According to opinion of Annette Susannah Beveridge (note 1320), Babur was the only Tīmūrid ruler and a man of achievement. He filled the vacuum post the death of Ḥusayn Bāī-qarā’s for Tīmūrid headship. If one observes Babur’s actions carefully, it would be found that he was trying hard from long to replicate footsteps of Tīmūr Beg. But there were few who did not admit of his suzerainty. She writes in note 1320, ‘Tīmūrids who had rebelled, Moghūls who had helped them, and who would also have helped Sa‘īd Khān Chaghatāī, if he had not refused to be treacherous to a benefactor; there were also the Arghūns, Chīngīz-khānids of high pretensions.’ In the gone by times, the Moghūl Khāqāns were known as the Pādshāh (supreme). The term Pādshāh has been recorded historically as the style of at least Sātūq-būghra Khān Pādshāh Ghāzī; but no Tīmūrid had been raised by his style above all Mīrzās. But when the Tīmūrids had the upper hand, Babur’s Tīmūrid grandfather Abū-sa‘īd asserted his de facto supremacy over Babur’s Chaghatāī grandfather Yūnas (Haidar, 1895 pp. 82-83). It seems that for Babur, this assuming of the Khāqān style was a step to re-assert the Timurid Supremacy. This declaration of supremacy was very much synonymous to declaring over-lordship above Chaghatāī, Moghūl, and even over all the Mīrzās. Now that the Mīrzā Khān’s rebellion was put to an end, the Arghūns were beaten & lost all possessions, his old Aūzbeg foe was now sitting at a way lesser fearing distance, and Kābul was once more his own, the sky for Babur had no dark clouds.

50 It appears that ‘Khān’ in Humāyūn’s name may been sprouted from his mother’s family. I have failed to find any strong record to establish from whose family did Māhīm (his mother) came from. This hasn’t been addressed in primary sources written by Babur, Gulbadan and Abū’l-faẓl. Neither of them talks of her father’s name.

51 Babur has not given any record of his death.

52 According to the note 1326 of Annette Susannah Beveridge, most of these soldiers had fought on the side of Babur in Kandahār.